If you find yourself stuck writing programs for a browser that doesn't support the ECMAScript 5 feature that you want, you will need to polyfill. Sometimes you need to polyfill things you might think are essential, such as JSON.

The ECMAScript features supported by a particular browser depend on which version of which JavaScript runtime it uses. When writing programs, however, it's usually browser versions that are discussed. So that's what we'll discuss now. Table 13.2 shows which versions of major browsers support the ECMAScript 5 features that are discussed in this section.

**Table 13.2. Support for ECMAScript 5 in some popular browsers**

| Feature | IE8 | IE9 | IE10 | FF 4+ | Sf 6+ | Ch 7+ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Object.create | No | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| Object property descriptors | No | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| New array methods (e.g., map) | No | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| Strict mode | No | No | Yes[*] | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| Native JSON | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |

IE = Internet Explorer; FF = Firefox; Sf = Safari; Ch = Chrome

[*] = Known bugs in implementation

When you target a browser older than the ones in table 13.2 (Internet Explorer 7, Safari 5, or Firefox 3.5, for example), there's a good chance that it won't support the ECMAScript 5 features you want to use. In that case, it's best to consult the documentation for that browser.

So, what are these features and, more importantly, how will they be useful for your programs (such as Formulaic)?

### 13.2.2. Object.create

You know that `Object.create` produces a new object with an existing object as the prototype. What you might not know is that